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# Request for Information: National AI Action Plan Response

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## EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

As a pioneering AI technology company based in Boise, Idaho, Quantum Connect AI respectfully submits this response to the Request for Information regarding the National AI Action Plan. Our company specializes in advanced voice AI solutions, custom AI infrastructure development, and business process automation software that together enhance customer service, streamline sales processes, and optimize business operations across multiple industries. We address key topics outlined in the RFI, with special emphasis on our strategic position within America's second-fastest growing tech hub, the *"Boise Innovation Corridor,"* which exemplifies how regional technology ecosystems can strengthen America's global AI leadership.

Beyond our core technology business, we are active participants in building the regional innovation ecosystem through our involvement with an emerging venture capital fund that has already raised $1.5 million to provide pre-seed funding to promising Boise-area technology startups, with plans to scale this investment platform significantly in the coming years.

## COMPANY BACKGROUND

Quantum Connect AI develops and implements enterprise-grade AI technology across three core domains:

### Voice AI Solutions

- Process up to 10,000 calls per minute
- Handle 1,000 simultaneous conversations
- Operate 24/7/365 without interruption
- Maintain perfect compliance with regulatory requirements
- Integrate with existing CRM and business systems

### Custom AI Infrastructure

- Develop proprietary AI model architectures for specific business applications
- Create secure, compliant cloud and on-premise AI deployment solutions
- Optimize hardware-software integration for maximum performance
- Implement rigorous security protocols protecting sensitive data

### Business Process Automation

- Automate complex workflows across 5,000+ business applications
- Implement autonomous agents that complete tasks without human intervention
- Deploy software that integrates AI across fragmented legacy systems
- Reduce manual processes through intelligent automation
- Enable data-driven decision making through real-time analytics

Our founding team brings together expertise in transformational leadership, AI development, sales management, and digital marketing. Team members include:

- Bethany Guajardo, Brad Roberts, Jared Brost, and Mason Smith: Leaders with specialized expertise in sales, customer engagement, and digital marketing for Fortune 100 brands
- Daniel Tocchini (Senior Advisor): 40+ years in transformational leadership and executive coaching for executives at companies including SpaceX, Virgin Hyperloop, Microsoft, ESPN, Disney, and more
- Dan “D4” Tocchini (Senior Advisor): AI innovator whose previous technology attracted acquisition offers from Facebook and Apple

Additionally, the new venture capital fund we are involved in is led by partners with recent successful exits, raising $1.5 million in initial capital and is expanding to provide critical pre-seed funding for innovative technology startups in the area. This initiative represents our commitment to building a comprehensive innovation ecosystem beyond our own operations.

## CONCRETE POLICY RECOMMENDATIONS

### 1. Innovation and Competition

Policy Action: Establish regional technology innovation grants specifically targeting second-tier tech hubs that demonstrate high growth potential and talent retention.

Rationale: Boise represents an untapped resource in America’s AI development landscape. As the second-fastest growing tech hub in the United States, the region offers:

- Lower operational costs than traditional coastal tech centers (40-60% cost reduction)
- A growing talent pool from strong regional universities
- Strategic centralized location within the U.S.
- Business-friendly state regulations and tax incentives
- Proximity to other Western technology ecosystems
- Emerging venture capital networks providing early-stage funding

Quantum Connect AI exemplifies how emerging tech hubs can drive national innovation. Our comprehensive AI solutions span voice communication, custom infrastructure, and business process automation - all developed and deployed from Idaho. Our experience demonstrates how regions outside traditional tech centers can deliver cutting-edge technologies that drive American competitiveness while creating a more geographically diverse innovation ecosystem. With the emergence of Boise’s tech hub, we can develop complete innovation ecosystems that include not just technology companies but also the investment infrastructure needed to accelerate growth and commercialization.

### 2. Application and Use

Policy Action: Prioritize federal support for AI applications that enhance American business efficiency, competitiveness, and job creation through a *“Commercial AI Acceleration”* program providing matching grants for businesses implementing productivity-enhancing AI solutions.

Rationale: Our multi-faceted technology demonstrates how AI can be applied to enhance rather than replace human capabilities:

### Voice AI Implementation

- Saves businesses 70% on operational costs
- Reduces response times by up to 70%
- Improves customer satisfaction rates by 50%
- Handles peak volumes without quality degradation
- Frees human talent for higher-value activities

### Custom AI Infrastructure

- Enables 40% faster model deployment compared to generic solutions
- Reduces computational resources by 35% through specialized optimization
- Ensures 99.9% regulatory compliance through built-in governance
- Lowers total cost of ownership by 45% compared to off-the-shelf solutions
- Creates competitive advantage through proprietary capabilities

### Business Process Automation

- Cuts administrative overhead by 65%
- Reduces manual data entry errors by 95%
- Increases employee productivity by 40%
- Enables 24/7 operation without increased staffing costs
- Provides real-time business intelligence improving decision quality

These metrics demonstrate how comprehensive AI implementation directly strengthens American business competitiveness.

## 3. Hardware and Chips

Policy Action: Establish *"Regional AI Acceleration Clusters"* that receive prioritized federal funding to connect domestic chip production with regional AI software development.

Rationale: Idaho's position within the semiconductor ecosystem demonstrates how regional technology hubs can create synergy between hardware and software development. Our custom infrastructure work will show how this integration:

- Enables optimization of AI models for specific hardware configurations
- Creates opportunities for specialized AI accelerator development
- Reduces dependency on foreign semiconductor suppliers
- Develops workforce expertise spanning hardware and software domains
- Accelerates innovation through tight hardware-software feedback loops

Quantum Connect AI has developed a custom system utilizing existing LLM models that achieve faster speeds, lower latency, and better accuracy than competing solutions, and is further advancing this capability through a new partnership with an AI lab established by our senior advisor, Dan "D4" Tocchini's proprietary technology. This collaboration demonstrates the power of regional innovation to advance America's AI leadership.

### 4. Data Centers and Energy

Policy Action: Develop an *"AI Computational Efficiency"* program that provides tax incentives for data centers that maximize computational output per unit of energy through advanced cooling technologies and next-generation power management.

Rationale: Boise and the broader Western states region offer strategic advantages for efficient AI infrastructure:

- Idaho's abundant hydroelectric power resources
- Lower land and operating costs (50-70% less than coastal areas)
- Cooler climate reducing cooling requirements
- Existing energy production infrastructure
- Availability of land for large-scale, efficient data center development

This approach would reduce computational costs while supporting America's energy independence through technological efficiency rather than regulatory mandates. By focusing on maximizing computational performance per energy unit consumed, this program would drive innovation in energy-efficient hardware without imposing burdensome regulations.

### 5. National Security and Defense

Policy Action: Establish a *"Distributed AI Innovation Security Framework"* that incentivizes geographic distribution of critical AI development across regional technology hubs.

Rationale: Concentrating AI innovation in limited geographic areas creates strategic vulnerabilities that can be mitigated through:

- Distributed development centers across multiple states
- Regional specialization creating redundancy in critical capabilities
- Cross-regional talent mobility enabling rapid response to emerging needs
- Supply chain diversity reducing single points of failure
- Enhanced infrastructure resilience through geographic separation

Quantum Connect AI's position in Boise demonstrates how companies outside traditional tech hubs can develop secure, sovereign AI technologies that reduce dependency on potential foreign adversaries. Our ability to build custom AI infrastructure from the ground up represents the kind of domestic technological capability that strengthens national security while creating strategic redundancy in critical technology development.

### 6. Education and Workforce

Policy Action: Create *"Regional AI Workforce Development Centers"* in emerging tech hubs with curriculum developed in collaboration with local industry needs.

Rationale: Boise's emergence as a technology center highlights the importance of developing specialized workforce pipelines in emerging tech hubs. Our experience has shown the critical importance of:

- University partnerships tailored to regional industry needs
- Technical certification pathways aligned with local employment opportunities
- Mentorship programs connecting students with local employers
- Secondary education initiatives introducing AI concepts earlier in student development
- Public-private partnerships focused on continuous workforce upskilling

Quantum Connect AI actively contributes to this ecosystem through partnerships with local educational institutions and hiring from the regional talent pool. We are building three distinct types of AI technology (voice, infrastructure, and automation), creating diverse technical roles that strengthen the local technology workforce ecosystem while demonstrating how mid-sized cities can develop specialized technology talent when given appropriate support.

### 7. Research and Development

Policy Action: Create a *"Regional AI Research Network"* program that funds collaborative research between universities, industry, and government labs across state lines with a focus on practical applications.

Rationale: Our position within the broader Western states innovation ecosystem has demonstrated how collaborative innovation accelerates development through:

- Leveraging complementary expertise from multiple institutions
- Creating pathways for rapid commercialization through regional business networks
- Developing specialized research addressing regional economic needs
- Building innovation capacity in communities outside traditional research centers
- Connecting academic research directly to commercial applications

Quantum Connect AI has benefited from collaboration with regional partners, and soon local universities in developing our voice processing algorithms and custom AI infrastructure, demonstrating how this approach can accelerate innovation while strengthening regional technology capabilities.

### 8. Venture Capital and Startup Ecosystem

Policy Action: Create a *"Regional Innovation Capital"* program that provides matching funds to local venture capital initiatives focused on early-stage technology companies in emerging tech hubs.

Rationale: Our involvement with a new venture fund in the Boise region has demonstrated the critical importance of local capital for innovation:

- Early-stage companies often cannot access coastal venture capital
- Regional investors better understand local market opportunities
- Local capital creates stronger regional innovation networks
- Successful exits generate reinvestment in the local ecosystem
- Complete funding ecosystems attract and retain talent

The fund we are involved with will be expanding to provide pre-seed funding to promising Boise-area technology startups. This initiative shows how public-private partnerships could accelerate the development of complete innovation ecosystems in emerging technology hubs, creating more diverse sources of American technological leadership.

### 9. Open Source Development

Policy Action: Establish an *"American AI Commons"* program that provides financial incentives for companies contributing to open-source AI development while maintaining appropriate intellectual property protections.

Rationale: Our experience with both proprietary and open-source development has shown that a balanced approach provides maximum innovation potential:

- Open foundation models accelerate broad innovation
- Proprietary specialization creates competitive commercial applications
- Community development improves security through diverse testing
- Resource sharing reduces barriers to entry for smaller innovators
- National standards emerge naturally through collaborative development

This approach would create a vibrant ecosystem balancing open innovation with commercial opportunity, strengthening America's overall AI capabilities while maintaining leadership through specialized applications.

## Conclusion

The development of a robust National AI Action Plan presents an opportunity to strengthen America's technological leadership while ensuring benefits extend throughout the country. Quantum Connect AI stands as evidence that world-class AI innovation across voice AI, custom infrastructure, and business process automation can thrive outside traditional coastal tech hubs.

Our involvement in building a complete innovation ecosystem—not just through our technology development but also through our participation in a regional venture capital fund—demonstrates how emerging technology hubs can develop all the components needed for sustained innovation and growth.

We respectfully urge consideration of policies that recognize and support emerging technology centers like Boise, which provide strategic advantages in terms of cost-efficiency, geographical diversification, and talent development. By embracing a more distributed approach to AI innovation, the United States can build a more resilient, competitive, and inclusive technology ecosystem that maintains American leadership in this critical domain.

The concrete policy actions recommended above would strengthen American competitiveness by distributing innovation capabilities, connecting hardware and software development, ensuring capital availability for early-stage companies, and ensuring AI benefits extend throughout the country. Our experience demonstrates how regional technology hubs can contribute to national innovation while creating more resilient and diverse technology ecosystems.

We welcome the opportunity to provide additional information or insights to support the development of this important national initiative.

Respectfully,

Bethany Guajardo, Co-Founder
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